On the intervening night of November 7-8, when the Rahul Gandhi-led Bharat Jodo Yatra (BJY) was crossing over to Maharashtra from Telangana, Congress social media chairperson Supriya Shrinate, who was camping in Himachal Pradesh for the assembly election campaign, was wide awake well past midnight. The former journalist is no stranger to a nocturnal routine, but for the rest of her team stationed at Delhi's 15, Gurudwara Rakabganj Road (GRB), the night was pregnant with anticipation. They had been alerted about some captivating visuals that would arrive from the Telangana-Maharashtra border. Eventually, those dramatic videos of Rahul Gandhi-led BJY yatris entering Maharashtra at night, the blazing *mashal*s (torches) in their hands breaching the engulfing darkness, landed at their work stations.

After some quick editing, a few WhatsApp exchanges between Shrinate and Srivatsa Y.B., who looks after the social media accounts of Rahul Gandhi, and a go-ahead from Jairam Ramesh, AICC general secretary in-charge of communications, Congress social media handles across various digital platforms came abuzz with images of Rahul Gandhi's night march in the homeland of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj. By the time

ANI



THE PARTY'S SOCIAL MEDIA WARRIORS



JAIRAM RAMESH, 68,
Rajya Sabha MP, AICC General Secretary in-charge Communications

Unlike previous communication heads, Ramesh oversees the party's social media wing. He decides the larger framework of social media content. His social media credo: ACT (Aggressive, Cohesive and Timely). He heads a team of eight people



SUPRIYA SHRINATE, 45,
AICC Chairperson, Social Media and Digital Platforms

The journalist-turned-politician leads a team of around 60 members who are engaged in running the party's social media campaign across all platforms. Average age of the team is 27. They operate from 15, Gurudwara Rakabganj Road in Delhi



SRIVATSA Y.B., 39,
Head, Rahul Gandhi's social media team

The Gandhi scion's social media campaign is handled by a team of 10 headed by Srivatsa Y.B., a former MNC executive. He was earlier the social media head of the Karnataka Congress. Srivatsa's team works in coordination with Ramesh and Shrinate's teams

Teen Bandar

The Mumbai-based digital outreach company has been **hired to help the Congress social media team during the Bharat Jodo Yatra**. It has designed the logo, composed the yatra's anthem and manages its website. Teen Bandar is run by Prashant Chari and Savio Joseph